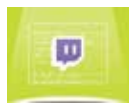




Telling animals apart

Here's a handy guide for correctly distinguishing between similar animal pairs.
<https://digit.in/oct19-35>



Learn coding with Twitch

People are flocking to the popular streaming platform to learn to be better programmers.
<https://digit.in/oct19-46>

Ora community divulged to Reuters, that they believe that the high number of twins in the town is because of the okra leaves they regularly consume.

CANDIDO GODOI, BRAZIL

Candido Godoi city in Brazil, near the Argentine border, also exhibits a similar phenomenon. The twinning rate in this city is also cited to be around 10 per cent, which is absurdly high considering the overall 1.8 per cent rate for the state of Rio Grande do Sul, where the curious city is situated.

One possible reason could be that the population of this city is largely of Polish or German descent, with many families tracing ancestry back to the Hunsrück region of Germany. This region in Germany did sport a higher than average twinning rate. Researchers who have extensively delved into this phenomenon believe that the cause of these abnormal twinning rates could be genetic or could be connected to inbreeding (breeding within the close family).



Josef Mengele, also known as the Angel of Death, has been speculated to have carried out experiments on twins in South America.

However, in 2009, Jorge Camarasa, an Argentine historian proposed a very outlandish theory in his book named 'Mengele: The Angel of Death in South America'. In his book, he extensively talks about Josef Mengele, a Nazi doctor, who conducted abhorrent twin experiments with twins in the Auschwitz German concentration camp. With the support of Adolf Hitler, he carried out these experiments to discover the secret to women producing more twins in order to artificially increase the Aryan population rapidly. When the Allies began

attacking the Nazis, Mengele apparently fled to South America. Camarasa suggests that Mengele continued his experiments here and was successful in cracking the 'twin code'. However, this speculation has been disputed by local historians and researchers who state that the high frequency of twins predates Mengele's arrival.

KODINHI VILLAGE, KERELA, INDIA

The remote village located in Kerala's Malappuram district has the highest twinning rate recorded in the country, with at least 400 pairs of twins documented in a population consisting of only 2,000 families. This is staggering since India is known to have one of the lowest twinning rates across the world, with a national average of a meagre 9 pair of twins per 1,000 births. In contrast, Kodinhi far surpasses this number with around 45 pairs of twins recorded per 1,000 live births. In 2010, a local doctor, Dr Krishnan Sribiju told the Daily Mail that the number of twins in the village is increasing with every passing year.

In October 2016, researchers from numerous institutes such as CSIR-Centre for Cellular and Molecular Biology, Hyderabad, Kerala University of Fisheries and Ocean Studies (KUFOS) and University of London and Germany visited the village to understand the reason behind this phenomenon which has confounded scientists and researchers across the world in their previous attempts to demystify it.

Reportedly, the researchers collected saliva as well as hair samples from the twins to investigate their DNA, however, other than multiple speculations, nothing has been proven scientifically. The process of analysing the samples they have collected is still an on-going process and researchers and scientists bewildered by this phenomenon in Kodinhi

FUN FACT

Multiple reports indicate that women native to Kodinhi village have exhibited high twin birth rates even when they moved away and started families!

are hoping for answers. Speaking of bewilderment, let's get into why Kodinhi continues to be a scientific mystery. First of all, IVF or artificial insemination techniques are sometimes connected with the increase of twin rates, however, in Kodinhi, this is not a possibility because of the exorbitant costs. According to reports, The diet of the village women is also ruled out

as a possible cause since there's nothing out of the ordinary that they eat which the surrounding areas don't.

Let's get to some more abnormalities. According to Dr Krishnan Sribiju, twins are usually born to older, more mature women. However, in Kodinhi, women pretty much conceive as soon as they get married, which is at around 18-20 years of age. The height of women in Kodinhi is estimated to be around 5ft in average which debunks yet another condition under which twins are born - twins are usually born to relatively taller women that are above 5 feet 3 inches in height.



Twins in Kodinhi village pose for a photograph.

The locals are proud of their surprisingly high twinning rates in all of the aforementioned towns and take pride in showing off their peculiar twin town and even using it to reel in tourists with signboards displaying 'Twin Town' or 'Twin Village'. In Kodinhi, the twins have established a foundation named TAKA (Twins and Kins Association), which attempts to educate and help those who bear twins. **4**

Source: Niklas Hallén / Barcroft Media